Scale Exercises - Section IV, Level 30

The pentatonic section starts on A.

Major Pentatonic One-Octave One-Fret Neck Ladder: A to A

Remove degrees 4 and 7; learn the balanced 2-2-2 string geometry; transpose the complete shape one fret at a time.

1. Hear what disappears

A major: A B C# D E F# G# A

A major pent.: A B C# E F# A

Omit degrees 4 (D) and 7 (G#).

2. Keep the 2-2-2 shape exact

Low E: R, R+2 (fingers 2,4).

A and D: R-1, R+2 (fingers 1,4).

Four-fret frame: R-1 through R+2.

3. Preserve rhythm through the shift

Ascend 1-2-3-5-6-8; repeat the root.

The 12-note cell preserves the pick start.

Shift only after the final low root.

Worked example - A major pentatonic at low-E fret 5

Scale notes: A B C# E F# A. The two printed high roots at the center are the turnaround.

OMISSION CHECK D (4) and G# (7) are deliberately absent.

UP 1-2-3-5-6-8 | DOWN 8-6-5-3-2-1

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------4--7--7--4-------------|
A  |------4--7--------------7--4--------|
E  |5--7-------------------------7--5--|
```

KEY ROUTE A -> Bb -> B -> C -> Db -> D -> Eb -> E -> F -> Gb -> G -> Ab -> A, then reverse.

IMPORTANT Moving one fixed shape transposes it. Fixed-key five-position work comes later.

Session protocol

1. Compare A major and A major pentatonic once; name the omitted 4th and 7th.
2. Choose 3-4 neighboring pentatonic rungs for the first session.
3. Use even eighth notes and repeat the high root at the turn.
4. Pause one beat after each 12-note cell; move the whole frame one fret.
5. Repeat with a downstroke start and an upstroke start.
6. Remove the pause, connect the route, and reverse at fret 17.

Level 30 - Chromatic Major-Pentatonic Route

Ascending route: complete each 12-note cell, then move the frame +1 fret

Descending route: use the same cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

Rung	Key	Low-E root	Frame	Scale tones (degrees 1, 2, 3, 5, 6)
01	A major pentatonic	fret 5	4-7	A B C# E F#
02	Bb major pentatonic	fret 6	5-8	Bb C D F G
03	B major pentatonic	fret 7	6-9	B C# D# F# G#
04	C major pentatonic	fret 8	7-10	C D E G A
05	Db major pentatonic	fret 9	8-11	Db Eb F Ab Bb
06	D major pentatonic	fret 10	9-12	D E F# A B
07	Eb major pentatonic	fret 11	10-13	Eb F G Bb C
08	E major pentatonic	fret 12	11-14	E F# G# B C#
09	F major pentatonic	fret 13	12-15	F G A C D
10	Gb major pentatonic	fret 14	13-16	Gb Ab Bb Db Eb
11	G major pentatonic	fret 15	14-17	G A B D E
12	Ab major pentatonic	fret 16	15-18	Ab Bb C Eb F
13	A major pentatonic - octave	fret 17	16-19	A B C# E F#

How to use the map

Up pass:

rungs 01-13.

Turn:

finish the high-A cell at fret 17, then reverse.

Down pass:

rungs 12-01. Skip the high-A card unless starting a new round trip.

Key names:

flat spellings keep the major keys easy to read.

Goal:

hear the same five-note formula as the root rises and falls.

Mastery gate before the next major-pentatonic level

Name every key before playing it; sing or say 1-2-3-5-6; keep the four-fret frame compact; land the new root without sliding; preserve equal note length and volume through the balanced 2-2-2 string pattern; complete the full fret-5 to fret-17 to fret-5 route with both pick starts; and recover the correct key after a deliberate random stop.

ROUND-TRIP COUNT 25 cells x 12 notes = 300 picked notes.

Level 30 - Major Pentatonic One-Fret Neck Ladder

Rungs 01-04: play each card as one cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

01 A MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E5 | FRAME 4-7

Notes: A B C# E F# A

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------4--7--7--4-------------|
A  |------4--7-------------7--4--------|
E  |5--7-------------------------7--5--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

02 BB MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E6 | FRAME 5-8

Notes: Bb C D F G Bb

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------5--8--8--5-------------|
A  |------5--8-------------8--5--------|
E  |6--8-------------------------8--6--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

03 B MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E7 | FRAME 6-9

Notes: B C# D# F# G# B

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------6--9--9--6-------------|
A  |------6--9-------------9--6--------|
E  |7--9-------------------------9--7--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

04 C MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E8 | FRAME 7-10

Notes: C D E G A C

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------7--10-10-7-------------|
A  |------7--10------------10-7--------|
E  |8--10------------------------10-8--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

Level 30 - Major Pentatonic One-Fret Neck Ladder

Rungs 05-08: play each card as one cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

05 DB MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E9 | FRAME 8-11

Notes: Db Eb F Ab Bb Db

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------|
D  |------------8--11-11-8--------------|
A  |------8--11-------------11-8--------|
E  |9--11-------------------------11-9--|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

06 D MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E10 | FRAME 9-12

Notes: D E F# A B D

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------|
D  |------------9--12-12-9--------------|
A  |------9--12-------------12-9--------|
E  |10-12-------------------------12-10-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

07 EB MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E11 | FRAME 10-13

Notes: Eb F G Bb C Eb

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------|
D  |------------10-13-13-10-------------|
A  |------10-13-------------13-10-------|
E  |11-13-------------------------13-11-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

08 E MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E12 | FRAME 11-14

Notes: E F# G# B C# E

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-------------------------------------|
B  |-------------------------------------|
G  |-------------------------------------|
D  |------------11-14-14-11-------------|
A  |------11-14-------------14-11-------|
E  |12-14-------------------------14-12-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

Level 30 - Major Pentatonic One-Fret Neck Ladder

Rungs 09-12: play each card as one cell, then move +1 fret

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

09 F MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E13 | FRAME 12-15

Notes: F G A C D F

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------12-15-15-12-------------|
A  |------12-15-------------15-12-------|
E  |13-15-------------------------15-13-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

10 GB MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E14 | FRAME 13-16

Notes: Gb Ab Bb Db Eb Gb

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------13-16-16-13-------------|
A  |------13-16-------------16-13-------|
E  |14-16-------------------------16-14-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

11 G MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E15 | FRAME 14-17

Notes: G A B D E G

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------14-17-17-14-------------|
A  |------14-17-------------17-14-------|
E  |15-17-------------------------17-15-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

12 AB MAJOR PENTATONIC

ROOT E16 | FRAME 15-18

Notes: Ab Bb C Eb F Ab

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------15-18-18-15-------------|
A  |------15-18-------------18-15-------|
E  |16-18-------------------------18-16-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

Level 30 - Major Pentatonic One-Fret Neck Ladder

Rung 13 and full-ladder consolidation

For the descending pass, read the cards in reverse order and move -1 fret

13 A MAJOR PENTATONIC - OCTAVE

ROOT E17 | FRAME 16-19

Notes: A B C# E F# A

12-NOTE UP/DOWN CELL

```
Deg|1--2--3--5--6--8--8--6--5--3--2--1--|
Fng|2--4--1--4--1--4--4--1--4--1--4--2--|
e  |-----------------------------------|
B  |-----------------------------------|
G  |-----------------------------------|
D  |------------16-19-19-16------------|
A  |------16-19-------------19-16-------|
E  |17-19-------------------------19-17-|
```

Finish on the low root; release pressure; move the entire frame one fret.

D-start and U-start

Full round-trip challenge

1. Start with A major pentatonic at fret 5.
2. Play all 13 cells without restarting the pick cycle.
3. Reverse at fret 17 and return through rungs 12-01.
4. Name each key and say 1-2-3-5-6 before its root.
5. Repeat with the opposite starting stroke.

Clean-round standard: no open strings, shift scrape, missing tone, or uneven 2-2-2 crossing.

300 picked notes per complete round trip.

After the basic ladder is clean

Full-scale contrast: play one A-major cell, then the A-major-pentatonic cell; hear the missing 4 and 7.

Chord-tone focus: accent degrees 1, 3, and 5; then hear 2 and 6 as color tones.

Rhythm: eighth notes, straight sixteenths, then six-note ascent/descent bursts.

Direction: begin some sessions at fret 17 and descend first.

Random entry: choose any root fret from 5-17, name the major key, play its cell, then continue either way.

Practice log

Date	BPM	Start stroke	Clean route?	Notes

Advance after two separate clean days, not one unusually good run.